

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

SUNDAY, 20 SEPTEMBER 2026

0 must-know stories, 3 Prelims facts, 0 editorials and 3 explainers, picked from 13 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

GOVERNANCE & POLICY

SCHEME

QUICK READ

Govt rolls out GOBARDhan rules with assured CBG offtake, 10-year price support

The government's Rs 23,731-crore GOBARDhan scheme aims to give India's CBG industry a more predictable business model, with assured offtake, a government-backed price for at least 10 years and capital support. The framework seeks to address buyer and financing concerns, while turning agricultural waste, cattle dung and other organic waste into energy.

[Economic Times: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

REPORT/INDEX

JUDGMENT

QUICK READ

Supreme Court refuses extension for Aravalli panel, sets November 30 deadline for final report

High-powered committee is tasked with evolving a uniform definition for the ecologically fragile Aravalli hills and range, and recommending measures to regulate mining in the region...

[The Hindu: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

QUICK READ

BRICS condemns EU carbon tax

Calls for a significant increase in international funding to help developing countries adapt to climate change

[The Hindu: source](#)

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Why has the U.S. deployed 'weapons' in space? What is a 'space control' weapon? Are there treaties limiting weapons deployments in space?

[The Hindu](#)

The price of AI is falling; why are enterprises still spending more? Explained Cheaper tokens are encouraging wider use while increasingly complex AI workloads drive up consumption

[The Hindu](#)

Why does India need to save more? A higher gross domestic savings rate is particularly important for India because sustaining 7-8% growth will require continued investment in infrastructure, manufacturing capacity, energy, technology, housing and human capital.

[Mint](#)

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- India's exports to core BRICS markets surge 34% in April-August; China leads (International Relations) [The Hindu](#)
- China drives India's BRICS export surge to \$19.9 billion; shipments to Japan, Italy, S Korea also gain (International Relations) [Mint](#)
- UPI's new MDR pot: 5% of collections to be used for bringing small merchants online (Economy) [Economic Times](#)
- From 68 to 145 Wetlands : How IFS Officer Sudhakar S Turned Bird Counts Into a Conservation Movement in Bihar (Environment & Ecology) [Indianmasterminds](#)

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 0 must-know, 3 Prelims facts, 4 in the news, 0 editorials, 3 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Governance & Policy (1), Polity & Constitution (1), International Relations (1). **Nothing today in** — Social Justice & Welfare, Health, Education, Economy, Agriculture & Allied, Infrastructure & Energy, Environment & Ecology, Science & Technology, Internal Security, Defence, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): nothing today · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 1 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: nothing today

Full text — 0 of 6 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 4, Economic Times 1, Mint 1

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